

#1
Childlike Lust

Your body, a fusion of wet dreams;
A cosmic journey to the highest skies.
My desire keeps me sleepless
I want you one more time.
If I cannot have you, by all means
My soul will retreat in agony
From such lovely lips, eyes and body.
I yearn; I cannot wait
I had a dream
That dream was you.
My mind: a childlike wonderland;
Blood rushes, head spins, belly tickles
All at the thought of you.
My soul sighs in hope
Of you, charming one,
That you come and ride with me
To the south western sun
Everyday becoming by dream
When I then wake up

/2014

Written between 2012-2021 by Tânia Silva

#2
Please Send me an Angel

Please send me an angel
To end my misery,
To die a little more in pleasure.
Send me an angel
And I'll go straight to hell.
I run from you,
For my desire burns within,
You might be just a lone angel in disguise.
Heaven and Earth,
There's so many of you; yet only one you.
The way I fell for you, I cannot tell;
Perhaps it was the taste of your lips.
I've always longed for infatuation,
A reason to dream, but you…
My lust for you has become despair.
Badly, I yearn for you.
If it's not the gods' wishes
For us to be as one,
In my dreams you're mine
Until there's no time.
Together we shall perish,
In love, day by day,
A little more, a little more.

/2014

#3
Alone

Alone this trip is only mine.
Collect everything you can;
All the food, all the light,
All the love, all the sorrows,
All the fear, all the smiles.
When the time comes
Go to a land, very far away
Where no one knows your name.
When the time comes
You stand alone in the unknown.
Your memories are only yours,
Of a life solely your own.
Leave your mark or don't,
In the grand scheme,
It's irrelevant.
Go where no one knows you
And make it home.
It doesn't matter where,
You're all alone.

/2013 -translated from Portuguese

#4
A Prayer

Forgive me father,
For I have sinned.
I let the dark thoughts
Consume and overwhelm me.
They come and go,
They possess me.
Forgive me for my lust and sin,
For I have wandered in the darkness
For far too long.
My desires have taken hold of me.
I have no control.
I drink your wine
And I spit it out,
The blood fills my mouth.
As I walk the streets
I have no fear;
For nothing to me is dear.

/2014

#5
You Left

Can’t sleep,
Don’t want to dream.
Days are much the same
And my wanderlust is gone.
You left before I could even meet you
Wrong timing, you said.
There’s no timing in loneliness.

/2016



#6
Two Days

The poem you never read would say,
That life is more than just two days.
The sun still rises every morning,
And the night descends.
Even though you're no longer here
The mountains stand in the same place;
The sea, with the same scent of salt,
Bringing back memories of other times
That only matter because they are mine.
Life is short and passes quickly;
I was told as a child,
When time was nothing more than
An adult concept without importance.
Now I put my hands in my pockets.
All that's left are the wind, the sun,
The sea, and the trees.

/for Louie, 2012 -translated from Portuguese

#7
U-Bahn Rides with Louie

Time speeds with my eyes wide
Everyone looks the same.
One minute you’re here,
The next you’re not.
Time races like an underground train.
Where are you going?
You have nowhere to go.
Have a tea and go to sleep.

/U-Bahn rides with Louie, Dez. 2012

#8

Every time someone leaves comes grief.

#9
William Blake

Am i not the same
As I fly?
Don’t we both live,
Don’t we both die?

/after reading Blake, 2013



#10
Born Again

Be born again from suffering,
Form a new coat, change the shell,
And dive back in.
Keep pushing the stone, Sisyphus,
Burn your wings, Icarus.
Never stop loving, Sappho,
For in the end,
That’s the beauty of it.
And if the path is alone,
So be it.

/Sept. 2019

#11
Toxic Love

Sometimes I think that suffering
Makes me feel alive,
And that's why I suffer, and that's why I write,
Reliving the pain,
Seeking love, seeking despair.
Believing in unreal values;
Things that are not natural.
There cannot be anything more beautiful
Than suffering for love.

/Sept. 2020 -translated Form Portuguese



#12
Here Again

Once in a while
I lose myself wild
In earthly desire
And human fire
Once the flame is weak
Again I face the unknown
Me, myself and I
Earth and sky
Once my love dies
Where are all the butterflies?
Fruit flies, cherry pies
Nonsense, nonsense!
I lost myself there
I was going nowhere.
I salut you Whitman,
Thoreau, Kierkegaard, Buddha,
Jesus, Tolstoy, Hopper, Sylvia Plath,
My mother.

/2020



#13
Rise

We throw around the word "love"
Like an old flower,
Daughters of soldiers,
Wife-beaters, and dictators.
I’ve learned love from the palm of your hand,
Crushing my soul,
Like nothing was meant.
Love was never spoken of
Like a forbidden word,
Never thought of.
I believed that was love,
And like that, I loved many and
No one.
Sons and daughters of broken marriages,
Passed on from generation to generation.
I never learned how to love,
And all I know must be forgotten.
Who will teach me how to swim
In this vast ocean of despair?
What a sad human condition,
To not know love and not care.
To belittle, patronize, humiliate
Your child, your wife, your husband.
Who gave you the right?
To take away my pride,
Make me small, unworthy.
Normalizing the absence of love
And lack of kindness.
I stand against you
And everything you taught me.
Now I rise,
Against your matriarchal and
Religious morals.
I’ll do it all anew
Because I know better than you.
I step on you with my shoe.

/To my mother, August 2020

#14
Re-define Love

Love is care
Friendship
Sacrifice
Compromise
Love is fragile
Blessing
Growth
Respect
Love is oneself
And everyone
Forget everything you've read
Your parents
Movies
Pop literature
Shakespeare
Make it new
Make it better.

/August 2020

#15
It was Nothing but a Tear

„I don't love you anymore."
How strange to say it out loud;
Once the source of my suffering.
Joy and pain!
Was it love? How fragile can it be?
A delusion?
Like a wave breaking on the shore
It made me breathe,
It was wind,
Taste of salt;
Now utter indifference.
What once shook my core
Now means very little.
Love is sensitive;
It must be taken care of.
Frail emotions of passion!
My path to know love continues,
Now I know a little more.
Passion is a tear;
I wipe it with my finger,
Lick it dry,
Salty like the ocean.
Somewhere there must be love.

/2020

#16
A Stanza for Pessoa

My mind is a deceiver.
It deceives so well that
My heart knowing it’s being fooled
Believes in it.

#17
A Song for Louie

Without thinking, I write to you;
There is in me a need to talk to you.
Writing is the only place where I feel you.
Yesterday I was listening to Carl Sagan talking about
Our small and casual existence.
He spoke about man's absurd,
ironic need to centre himself in the universe.
[And Thoreau, who talked about materialistic excess,
of the worldly superfluities of the civilised being]
We forget to be grateful to the great Creator.
Fruits of a cosmic causality.
We forget that our bodies are not immortal,
Nor can they be.
For from death new creation is born;
We all share the same animal-like essence,
exaggerating our power and sovereignty.
We are small, as small as our planet
In this vast universe.
And even so, I think about you and how much I miss you
selfish reminiscing of the past.
We forget to be grateful for our existence, and then
typical of an "I" focused consciousness, we complain.
We complain to the Gods about our miseries, illnesses, deaths.
Our anxiety, the lack of respect and kindness to one another,
as if the Gods haven't given us enough already.
I am looking for you to tell you that I loved you, and still do.
To tell you that the light in your Eyes
still radiates in my Soul, who sings You
In love and joy.
That the little things, like us,
seek nourishment in one another.
I miss you but causality is part of Nature and You…
You were a gift from Her!

/for Louie, April 2014 -translated from Portuguese



#18
My Body Shivers with the Thought of You

I can't recall your scent,
Or even know if there was one.
Light streamed through the only window in the room,
The room that watched me grow
From child to teen,
Where I stored all my secrets within its walls.
Endless hours in bed,
Staring at the ceiling on hot summer nights,
The warmth preventing thought and sleep.

I wrote diaries and hid them from you
Behind shelves and clothes,
Yet you always found them.

I could hear your footsteps nearing;
You never knocked.
You would simply enter, for between us
There were no secrets; flesh of my flesh.

You'd wake me up every morning,
And sometimes, as a child,
We'd fall asleep with our legs entwined.
With a heavy hand, you overpowered my spirit.
I carried your harsh words with me,
Yet I never understood them—
Not then, not now.

I walked beside you until the very end,
Watching you weaken from a distance.
The weaker you became, the less you controlled me,
Yet anxiety consumed me.

I didn't weep for you;
Instead, I searched for you.
Today, I still seek to fill the void you left.
Every morning, I awake with hope
To find you in the spaces we shared:
Racing through your room, the attic,
The forest behind the house, the terrace,
Within your wardrobe, your scent amidst your clothes.

I continue my search,
Not through tears, but in the faces of others,
Seeking glimpses of you in everyone I meet.

/to my mother, 2013 -translated from Portuguese

#19
The Dog is Barking into the Nothingness

I used to be empty,
Now I'm full.
Full of what?
Nothingness still all around,
In every corner,
In every word.
Remember those days after Louie
Those U-Bahn rides
Back and forward in the dark
Talking to someone who's gone.
Nothing mattered.
If I lack empathy,
Which I don't,
It's because nothing is forever.

/Dez. 2018 – the days after Louie's death

#20
Untitled #17

You left me,
Just like that.
My heart pumps
As fast as the rain drips
Outside the window.
Was it enjoyable for you?
All that I am—
Did you leave for good?
I hope you enjoyed yourself.

[Love is a lie]



#21
Sun Kissed

My most vivid memory of you
Is of your sun-kissed chest.
It tasted like saltwater,
With the sun's warmth trapped within.
Like a crab shell against my ear,
I'd hear the waves from Caparica.
Each birthmark forming a map,
Marking places where I've been.

/November 2019



#22
Loneliness =

The longing for something:
A feeling, a connection,
A touch, a kiss,
A tear.
I don't know what it is that I long for,
That warm place at the back of my heart.
When it hurts, it stings -
Like a sharp edge cutting flesh.
I told you to leave,
Yet I longed for you.

/December 2020

#23
Longing Never Ends

It's never truly over,
This constant longing:
For something, for someone.
I find myself falling for you.
The sweetness of your touch,
The kisses on your soft brown skin,
Your lips pressing gently against mine,
I'm drawn to you, but
Falling brings pain,
Yearning for your words stings.
In this ache of feeling unwanted
I'm old enough to know better,
Yet too young to do differently.
I'm in descent,
And the hurt has begun.

/For N., December 2021

#24
Untitled #47

Your skin
Sun tanned
Sun kissed
On my lips
Every kiss pure bliss.
Loving you was my only delight
In my darkest time
Thank you.

[Remember to always ask the child in you how she’s feeling.
No one did that then]

#25
Don‘t Belong Here

I dislike our generation
I don’t belong here
Superficial, temporary,
I don’t belong here.
I don’t belong anywhere
There’s no hope
There’s no home
Welcome back, Black Dog,
You never truly left.



1.

#26
Déjà Vu

Thank you for the love but I don’t want to fall in love again

#27
Untitled #91

How can it be that one week
I feel an immense existential dread?
I sleep and wake up in despair,
Yet the next week, I feel incredibly well.
If hormones play a role, I'll be damned.
I feel good on my own.
I only find peace of mind and happiness
When I can truly be myself.
I feel comfortable in my shoes,
Longing to read and dive
Into poetry once again.

[Welcoming the fleeting tranquility within my soul]

#28
Untitled #32

I forgot how to write, words stumble around my mouth...

Pixelated puzzles
Deconstructed thoughts
Fictional introspection
The mind's tangled knots.

#29
Death Walks Beside Me!

Sometimes death walks beside me,
A constant reminder of its permanence,
And how, at any moment, it could come for me.

I think about my books and cameras,
These cherished things I hold so dear.
Who will care for them
After I'm gone?

/2021

#30
Draft #14

I miss feeling things deeply
The heart skipping a beat
The sunset at the beach
The butterflies in the stomach



#31
Dream #47

I dreamt last night
That I was chasing a scorpion at my parents' house.
At first, it looked dead, and I touched it.
But when it ran, I chased it.
A moment froze—
I could have stepped on it, killed it,
But I didn't.
I chased it to the kitchen,
Terrified by its size,
And watched it hide.
I grabbed the insecticide,
But as I sprayed,
All I could think about
Was the food lying in the sink.

#32
Draft #7

Another dream with you, darling!
Do memories get lost in time?
Another way to make you mine;
The children got older.

/March 2020



#33
Dream #62

I drank glass.
I could see it opening the wounds from my insides,
Along my digestive system,
from my breast to my belly.
Next day I woke up, my chest full of pieces of glass,
Sticking out of my flesh.
I started to hand-pick the pieces out.

/Jan. 2020

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